Tony Wang Li

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Research Interests

Human-Computer Interaction: I am interested in exploring how AI can help people connect on a human level. Specifically, I want to empower everyday people to tell their stories and build connections with technologists to inspire user empathy in human-centered products and services.

Education

2023–Present **Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering (Anticipated)**, *University of California, San Diego*, La Jolla, California

2021–2023 **M.S. in Human Centered Design and Engineering**, *University of Washington*, Seattle, Washington
Capstone Project: National Park Services Visitor Experience Data

2013–2017 **A.B. in Computer Science, Secondary in Statistics**, *Harvard University*, Cambridge, Massachusetts
Senior Thesis: *Approaches to Policy Advice From Multiple Teachers in Reinforcement Learning*

Peer-Reviewed Paper Publications

- **Tony W. Li**, Zhiqing Wang, Thanh-Nha Tran, Grace Yu-Chun Yen, and Steven P. Dow. Disentangling Threads: Exploring the Potential of LLM-Supported Discussion Forum Analysis for Community Insight. *ACM Collective Intelligence Conference*. 2026.
- **Tony W. Li**, Yunpeng Zhao, Yujin Zhang, R. Stuart Geiger, and Haojian Jin. Designing SocialTrust.md to Enhance Developer Awareness of Risks in Utilizing Open-Source GitHub Repositories. *ACM SIGCHI Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work & Social Computing (CSCW)*. 2026.
- **Tony W. Li**, Arshia Arya, and Haojian Jin. Redesigning Privacy with User Feedback: The Case of Zoom Attendee Attention Tracking. *ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2024.
- Yaqing Yang, **Tony W. Li**, and Haojian Jin. On the Feasibility of Predicting Users' Privacy Concerns using Contextual Labels and Personal Preferences. *ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2024.
- Emelia May Hughes, Renee Wang, Prerna Juneja, **Tony W. Li**, Tanushree Mitra, and Amy X. Zhang. Viblio: Introducing Credibility Signals and Citations to Video-Sharing Platforms. *ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2024.

- **Tony W. Li***, Yelin Jo*, Zander Brumbaugh, Hanna Lee, Michael Murray, and Elin A. Björling. **[Best Paper Award Winner]** Low-Effort, Unqualified, and Malicious User Behaviors in Online Human-Robot Interaction Studies. *ACM Special Interest Group on Design of Communication (SIGDOC)*. 2023.
- K. J. Kevin Feng, **Tony W. Li**, and Amy X. Zhang. Understanding Collaborative Practices and Tools of Professional UX Practitioners in Software Organizations. *ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2023.
- Raida Karim, Edgar Lopez, Katelynn Oleson, **Tony W. Li**, Elin A. Björling, and Maya Cakmak. Share with Me: A Study on a Social Robot Collecting Mental Health Data. *International Conference on Social Robotics (ICSR)*. 2022.

* Equal first-author contribution.

Peer-Reviewed Workshop and Short Paper Publications

- **Tony W. Li** and Steven P. Dow. User-Led Storytelling with Generative AI Artifacts to Promote Empathic Design. *EmpathiCH Workshop at ACM CHI*. 2026.
- **Tony W. Li**, Michael Murray, Zander Brumbaugh, Hanna Lee, Raida Karim, Maya Cakmak, and Elin A. Björling. Tell Me About It: Adolescent Self-Disclosure with an Online Robot for Mental Health. *ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI)*. 2023.

Honors and Awards

2024-2025 **Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews**, *ACM CHI, ACM CSCW, ACM IMWUT*

2024 **Department Service Award (Teaching)**, *Halıcıoğlu Data Science Institute*, UCSD

2023 **Best Paper Award**, *ACM Special Interest Group on Design of Communication (SIGDOC)*

Research Experience

2023–Present **Graduate Student Researcher**, *University of California, San Diego*, La Jolla, California
- Currently conducting research on collecting and communicating human feedback for empathic design insight with Prof. Steven Dow (ProtoLab)
- Conducted research on human-centered data privacy and software security resulting in three published papers, with Prof. Haojian Jin (AI Smith Lab)

2022–2023 **Graduate Research Assistant**, *University of Washington*, Seattle, Washington
Advisor: Amy Zhang (Social Futures Lab)
- Surveyed user experience (UX) collaboration in practice and recommended tooling design from qualitative coding
- Built crowdsourced video annotation tooling and evaluated with usability studies

2021–2023 **Graduate Research Assistant**, *University of Washington*, Seattle, Washington
Advisors: Elin Björling, Maya Cakmak (Project EMAR)
- Developed software-hardware integration for a social robot and an end-user programming platform for intervention and measurement of adolescent stress based on user research
- Evaluated online social robot interactions for adolescent mental health interventions through mixed-methods analyses

2022–2023 **Graduate Research Assistant**, *University of Washington*, Seattle, Washington
Advisors: Cecilia Aragon, Bernease Herman, Sarah Evans (Directed Research Group: Research Design for Games to Teach Data Ethics)
- Evaluated and developed game designs for ethics and diversity education in data science

Work Experience

2017–2021 **Data Engineer**, *Facebook*, Menlo Park, California
Artificial Intelligence Data Engineering
- Partnered with Facebook AI Research to source and manage data for computer vision projects, platformize visual model-free data sampling methods for Instagram images, and visualize annotation progress in an interactive dashboard
- Partnered with AI Data team to analyze and improve Facebook AI platforms with previously no data architecture
- Implemented ETL data foundations, alerting capabilities, and data visualization dashboards to track reliability, performance, efficiency, and label quality across AI Data platforms
- Designed and implemented frontend UI for internal customers to track and analyze machine learning dataset quality

Ads Interfaces Data Engineering
- Created and maintained data ETL, central data pipelines, and data visualization dashboards for Ads org-wide goal metrics and internal Dogfooding Programs formerly with no goaling metrics or data visibility
- Implemented an automated bot to post weekly metric movements internally to relevant stakeholders
- Crafted and delivered presentations on query optimization and data visualization

2014–2015 **Software Developer**, *Quorum Analytics*, Cambridge, Massachusetts
- Built an online legislative strategy platform performing big data analysis of the United States Congress
- Developed full-stack interactive data visualizations and quantitative profiles of political data

Teaching Experience

2024-2026 **Teaching Assistant**, *UC San Diego*
- Spring 2026 – *Introduction to Data Science* (COGS 9): Managed discussion sections, mentored 2 pedagogy and learning apprentices (PLAs), graded assignments and projects
- Winter 2026 – *Online Database Analytics and Applications* (CSE 135): Created and led discussion sections, held office hours, graded assignments and exams
- Fall 2025 – *Software Engineering* (CSE 110): Mentored and advised project teams (60 students), created and conducted technical lab sections, graded assignments and projects
- Spring 2025 – *Software Engineering* (CSE 110): Mentored and advised project teams (70 students), graded assignments and projects
- Winter 2025 – *Startup Studio* (COGS 122): Managed four instructional assistants to grade assignments and projects, created and led interactive studio sections, and organized attendance and assignments
- Fall 2024 – *Software Engineering* (CSE 110): Created and led interactive lab sections for technical skills, created and hosted discussion sections for soft engineering skills, mentored project teams (90 students), held office hours, and graded assignments and projects
- Spring 2024 – **[HDSI Department Service Award Recipient]** *Systems for Scalable Analytics* (DSC 102): Held office hours and graded homework assignments

2018–2019 **Data Engineer**, *Facebook*
Lectured on data visualization and SQL query optimization within the data engineering organization

2017 **Teaching Fellow**, *Harvard University - Computer Science*
Advanced Topics in Data Science (CS109b): Held teaching office hours and graded homework assignments

Leadership and Service

2024-2026 **Peer Reviewer**, *5 Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews*, ACM CHI (6 full papers, 1 late-breaking work); ACM DIS (2 full papers); ACM CSCW; ACM HCOMP and CI; ACM IMWUT; JMIR Formative Research

2023-2026 **Student Volunteer**, *ACM CHI, ACM CSCW, ACM HCOMP/CI, ACM SIGDOC*
Assisted participant check-in, event setup, technical setup/cleanup, and general coordination

2025-2026 **Graduate Student Mentor**, *UCSD Graduate Women In Computing*
Regularly met with and advised a master's student on research and career growth

2025-2026 **Co-Chair**, *UCSD Design Lab Impact and Student Culture Organization (DISCO)*
Budgeted, planned, and managed social events for Design Lab graduate students

2025 **Local Arrangements Conference Chair**, *ACM Collective Intelligence*
Coordinated with local venues and partners for the conference, provided invited guest speakers with arrangements and accommodations, and managed on-site venue logistics

2021–2023 **President**, *University of Washington HCDE Graduate Student Association*
Organized and coordinated social and professional events for 300 graduate students

2016–2017 **Design Director of Staff Development, Software Engineer**, *The Harvard Crimson*
Recruited designers for the school newspaper, lectured on design and web development skills, developed the newspaper's online website

2016–2017 **President**, *Harvard Chinese Music Ensemble*
Coordinated rehearsals and community performances with 8 members, performed on the *erhu* (traditional Chinese violin)

Technical Skills

Programming	Python, C/C++, Java
Web	HTML, CSS, JavaScript/React, PHP
Data Analysis	Python, SQL (MySQL, Hive/Spark, Presto), R
User Research	Interview, Survey, Usability Testing, Experimental Study Design, Design Prototyping (Figma, InDesign)